

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #2357

Name

Eleana Karachaliou

Email

karachae@myumanitoba.ca

Gender

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada

Nationality

Hellenic (Greek) & British

When did or will you finish your PhD?

Fall 2023 - Winter 2024

University Education

Ph.D. | Biological Sciences | Department of Biological Sciences, Faculty of Science, University of Manitoba | Fall 2023 - Winter 2024

M.Sc. | Systems Biology | Department of Biotechnology, Agricultural University of Athens | October 2019

Integrated B.Sc. & M.Sc. | Ichthyology & Aquatic Environment | Department of Agriculture, Ichthyology & Aquatic Environment, School of Agricultural Sciences, University of Thessaly | November 2017

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I believe it is a scientist's duty to contribute to mentoring the next generation. Training the next generation of scientists to become leaders in both their local communities and globally, so that they can contribute diverse world-views and knowledge, is essential for a future in which we are called to mitigate and adapt to climate change. Undertaking a Science Corps fellowship would help me build communication and teaching skills that will enable me to pursue the educational side of my field, gain more experience working in an international environment and expand my world-view. I believe that students should have the opportunity to connect with nature as part of their school curriculum and am eager for the opportunity to combine both work in the classroom and field as part of a real-life learning approach to the natural sciences. When choosing study organisms/systems as a teaching focus, I would be interested in researching what organisms and/or natural resources are of cultural value to the community I would be potentially teaching in, and which could be of use for addressing issues such as climate change mitigation, species conservation and food security in the area.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I have experience working in an international environment alongside people from different cultures, having undertaken an Erasmus exchange program in Austria (BOKU, Vienna), a summer school on aquatic field work in Denmark (DTU, Copenhagen) a workshop on molecular evolution in Finland (Konnevesi Research Station, University of Jyväskylä), and a research visit with the Columbia River Inter-Tribal Fish Commission & Yakama Nation Fisheries in the USA (Portland OR & Toppenish WA), as well as moving to Winnipeg, Canada to pursue a Ph.D. I have teaching experience that includes undertaking the position of Teaching Assistant and Grader/Marker in Evolutionary Biology for the last 2 years (fall semester) at the University of Manitoba, and spending a year working as an English Teaching Assistant at a bilingual school in Greece (Yellow Umbrellas Kindergarten, Athens). I also have good communication and presentation skills, having presented my work at both national and international conferences and seminars. I have also participated in an interactive display at a community outreach event with Yakama Nation Fisheries (Prescott, WA, USA), where we handled and showed members of the community Pacific lamprey and provided information on efforts for their conservation.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
 Doing science in industry
 In science education
 In science outreach
 Other

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

After finishing my Ph.D. I am hoping to pursue Post-doctoral research. I am currently in conversation regarding a project that involves working with Indigenous communities in the Laurentian Great Lakes area, combining local knowledge and scientific methods for informing conservation planning based on community priorities and needs. An integral part of this project will be involving local youth in scientific activities and working with local high schools to encourage student scientific interest. This project is at the early stages of planning and searching for funding, and I would hope to undertake a Science Corps fellowship in the time between finishing my Ph.D. and starting my Post-doctoral research. Long-term, I hope to pursue a career that balances my scientific field of interest, evolutionary biology with a focus on the aquatic environment, with environmental conservation and management planning. I hope to achieve this through working with local communities and assisting them address environmental/social issues of concern, while training the next generation of leaders and scientists. I would be interested in pursuing this through either academia, government, or non-governmental organizations, or through industry e.g. a local company focusing on seaweed aquaculture so as to provide affordable food and job opportunities in the region.

CV/Resume

 [KarachaliouE_CV2022.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

EvoDir

Any other comments/questions?

I would like to apply for the evolutionary biologist position at The Central Visayan Institute Foundation (CVIF) in the Philippines.

I expect to graduate Fall 2023 - Winter 2024 and would be available to start a Science Corps fellowship Spring, Summer or Fall 2024.

[Science Corps](#)